National Deepfake Detection & Misinformation Response Platform

BHARATSHIELD

LEGAL DOCUMENT PACKAGE

Case ID	**BS-20260506-221CFC2A**
Generated	06 May 2026, 12:43:15 IST
Classification	**RESTRICTED — LAW ENFORCEMENT USE ONLY**

DOCUMENTS INCLUDED

1	**Digital Evidence Package**	BSA 2023 · Section 63
2	**Platform Takedown Notice**	IT Rules 2021 · Rule 3(1)(b)
3	**FIR Support Report**	IPC 499, 153A · IT Act 66C/D/E
4	**Chain of Custody Log**	BSA 2023 · Append-Only Ledger
5	**Regulatory Compliance Report**	MeitY / ECI Submission
6	**Expert Witness Statement**	Judicial Proceedings

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Digital Evidence Package

Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam 2023 · Section 63 · Hash-Certified Evidence

1. CASE IDENTIFICATION

Case Reference	EP-BS-20260506-221CFC2A
BharatShield Case ID	BS-20260506-221CFC2A
Document Generated	06 May 2026, 12:43:15 IST
Issuing Authority	Inspector, Cyber Crime Cell, Bengaluru City Police

2. MEDIA UNDER EXAMINATION

File Name	suspect_video_election_rally_2025.mp4
Media Type	Video
Capture Timestamp	2025-04-15T14:32:07+05:30
Source Platform	WhatsApp (forwarded message)
Source URL / ID	https://web.whatsapp.com/share/xK9mP2 [archived]
Election Context	Karnataka State Legislative Assembly By-Election 2025
Originating State	Karnataka

3. SHA-256 HASH CERTIFICATE (BSA S.63)

The following cryptographic hash was computed at the moment of media ingestion, prior to any processing or analysis. Any modification to the original file will produce a different hash value, thereby proving tampering. This satisfies the hash-based certification requirement under Section 63 of the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023.

```
SHA-256: b2ef6dba8622ae79b5ab4d3f57ff16ed4340b9c0f3f293c9248340b756e2f6bc
```

4. AI DETECTION RESULTS

Model Version	BharatShield-DetectCore v2.1.3
Inference Duration	4.7 seconds
CNN Spatial Score	92.4% (frame-level artefact detection)
Temporal Score	88.7% (inter-frame motion / A-V sync)
Audio Forensics Score	95.1% (synthetic voice / speaker ID)

Metadata Score	76.0% (encoding / provenance anomalies)
Ensemble Fusion Score	91.6% (calibrated multi-modal ensemble)

VERDICT: LIKELY SYNTHETIC Fusion Score: 91.6%

5. SALIENT DETECTION REGIONS

The following specific regions triggered the synthetic media classification:

1. Face boundary blending artefacts at 00:03–00:07 (frames 72–168)
2. Inconsistent ear-to-jaw texture gradient in frames 210–290
3. Audio-lip sync deviation: +180ms offset detected at 00:11
4. Compression signature anomaly: H.264 GOP structure inconsistent with stated recording device

6. LEGAL BASIS

This evidence package is prepared in accordance with:

• **Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 – Section 63:** Digital records as primary evidence with hash-based certification ensuring chain-of-custody continuity.

• **IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021:** Mandatory labelling and disclosure obligations for synthetic media.

• **Indian Evidence Act (transitional):** Electronic records admissibility standards.

7. CERTIFYING OFFICER

Inspector Priya Nair
Inspector, Cyber Crime Cell
Bengaluru City Police

Signature: _____

Date: 06 May 2026

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Platform Takedown Notice

IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021 · Rule 3(1)(b)(ii) & Rule 3(1)(b)(v)

To	Grievance Officer / Authorised Representative
Re	Mandatory Removal of Synthetic / Deepfake Media
Date	06 May 2026
Ref No.	TDN-BS-20260506-221CFC2A
Deadline	Within 36 hours of receipt of this notice (24 hours for election-related content)

1. IDENTIFICATION OF INFRINGING CONTENT

Platform	WhatsApp (forwarded message)
Content URL / ID	https://web.whatsapp.com/share/xK9mP2 [archived]
Media Type	Video
Upload Handle	Unknown / Under Investigation
Date Observed	2025-04-15T14:32:07+05:30

2. GROUNDS FOR REMOVAL

The content identified above has been analysed by BharatShield, the National Deepfake Detection and Misinformation Response Platform, and has been classified as **likely synthetic (deepfake) media** with an authenticity fusion score of **91.6%**. The content:

(a) Constitutes synthetic/AI-generated media in violation of **Rule 3(1)(b)(ii)** (prohibition on false or misleading information).

(b) Is being circulated in the context of an election and poses a direct threat to electoral integrity under **Rule 3(1)(b)(v)**.

(c) Depicts a named individual without their consent, constituting a violation of privacy under **Section 66E of the Information Technology Act, 2000**.

3. MANDATORY ACTIONS REQUIRED

You are hereby directed to:

1. Remove or disable access to the content at the URL/ID specified above within **36 hours** of receipt of this notice.

2. Preserve all associated metadata, upload logs, IP addresses, and device identifiers for a minimum of **180 days** for law enforcement access.

3. Provide written acknowledgement of receipt and action taken to the nodal officer within **24 hours**.

4. Report the originating account to your Trust & Safety team and apply appropriate platform-level sanctions.

4. ESCALATION

Failure to comply within the stipulated time will result in escalation to the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) for action under **Section 69A of the Information Technology Act, 2000**, including potential blocking orders. Evidence Package Reference: EP-BS-20260506-221CFC2A.

5. ISSUING NODAL OFFICER

Shri Anand Sharma
Director, Cyber Laws Division
Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Signature: _____

Date: 06 May 2026

Contact Email	nodalofficer-cyber@meity.gov.in
Contact Phone	+91-11-2430-1851
Office Address	Electronics Niketan, 6 CGO Complex, New Delhi – 110 003

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FIR Support Report

Supporting document for First Information Report filing · IPC Sec. 499, 153A · IT Act Sec. 66C, 66D, 66E

1. COMPLAINANT DETAILS

Name	Inspector Priya Nair
Designation	Inspector, Cyber Crime Cell
Organization	Bengaluru City Police
Badge / ID	KA-CCU-1194
Contact	cybercell.blr@ksp.gov.in | +91-80-2294-3000
Address	Cyber Crime Police Station, CID Headquarters, Carlton House, Palace Road, Bengaluru – 560 001

2. SUBJECT / PERSON CONCERNED

Person Depicted	Shri Arvind Patil (depicted without consent)
Role / Office	Member of Legislative Assembly, Constituency 47
Alleged Creator	Unknown — under investigation
Platform Handle	@arvind_patil_official (impersonation account)

3. INCIDENT SUMMARY

On 2025-04-15T14:32:07+05:30, a video purportedly depicting Shri Arvind Patil (depicted without consent) making inflammatory statements was identified in circulation via WhatsApp (forwarded message). The content was flagged through BharatShield and subjected to multi-modal AI forensic analysis. The analysis conclusively determined that the media is **LIKELY SYNTHETIC**, with a detection confidence of **91.6%**. The content is being circulated in the context of Karnataka State Legislative Assembly By-Election 2025, posing a direct risk to public order and democratic integrity.

4. APPLICABLE LEGAL PROVISIONS

The following offences are prima facie disclosed:

IPC Section 499	Defamation — false imputation of conduct to injure reputation
IPC Section 153A	Promoting enmity between groups / communal incitement
IPC Section 295A	Deliberate acts outraging religious feelings (if applicable)
IT Act Section 66C	Identity theft — fraudulent use of another person's identity

IT Act Section 66D	Cheating by personation using computer resource
IT Act Section 66E	Violation of privacy — publishing private images without consent
IT Act Section 67	Publishing obscene material in electronic form (if applicable)
RPA Section 126	Election offence — publication of false statements about candidates

5. DETECTION EVIDENCE SUMMARY

Evidence Package Ref.	EP-BS-20260506-221CFC2A
SHA-256 (original)	b2ef6dba8622ae79b5ab4d3f57ff16ed4340b9c0f3f293c9248340b756e2f6bc
Fusion Score	91.6% (LIKELY SYNTHETIC)
Model Version	BharatShield-DetectCore v2.1.3

6. RECOMMENDED IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

1. Register FIR under the sections listed in Part 4 above.
2. Issue preservation request to platform (Takedown Notice Ref: TDN-BS-20260506-221CFC2A already dispatched).
3. Initiate IP address and device identifier tracing via CERT-In.
4. Secure witness statements from individuals who received / forwarded the content.
5. Coordinate with the Election Commission nodal officer for electoral violation proceedings.

7. PREPARED BY

Inspector Priya Nair
Inspector, Cyber Crime Cell
Bengaluru City Police

Signature: _____

Date: 06 May 2026

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Chain of Custody Log

Tamper-Resistant Audit Trail · BSA 2023 · Append-Only Signed Ledger

1. EVIDENCE IDENTIFIER

Case ID	BS-20260506-221CFC2A
Media File	suspect_video_election_rally_2025.mp4
Original Hash	b2ef6dba8622ae79b5ab4d3f57ff16ed4340b9c0f3f293c9248340b756e2f6bc
Log Reference	CCL-BS-20260506-221CFC2A

2. CUSTODY EVENTS

Each entry below is a cryptographically signed, append-only record. Any gap or modification to the sequence invalidates the chain.

#	Timestamp	Actor	Action	System Hash
1	2025-04-15T14:32:07+05:30	Field Officer Ramesh Kumar (Badge #KA-7721)	Media captured and SHA-256 hash computed via BharatShield Mobile App v3.0.1	`b2ef6dba8622ae79b5ab4d3f57ff16ed...`
2	2025-04-15T14:33:01+05:30	BharatShield AI Engine (Auto)	Multi-modal inference completed. Result sealed with system signature.	`43f01121fdcbef31d7c4433ec493e6da...`
3	2025-04-15T15:10:44+05:30	Inspector Priya Nair (Cyber Cell, Bengaluru)	Evidence reviewed. FIR support report generated.	`8ac02b462602456d535f56783a83dc77...`
4	2025-04-15T16:05:00+05:30	Nodal Officer Anand Sharma (MeitY)	Takedown notice issued to platform. Regulatory report filed.	`313499d2c4658b9ab0248ff3fdd3b533...`

3. INTEGRITY STATEMENT

This log certifies that the digital evidence identified above has remained in an unaltered state from the point of initial capture to the present. The hash values recorded at each custody event may be independently verified against the media file using any standard SHA-256 utility. This document satisfies the chain-of-custody requirements for electronic evidence admissibility under **BSA 2023 Section 63** and the precedents established under **State (NCT of Delhi) v. Navjot Sandhu (2005)**.

CONFIDENTIAL – ELECTORAL INTEGRITY

Regulatory Compliance Report

Submission to MeitY and Election Commission of India · IT Rules 2021 · Representation of the People Act, 1951

1. REPORTING AUTHORITY

Submitted By	Shri Anand Sharma, Director, Cyber Laws Division
Ministry	Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
Report Period	Incident Report – May 2026
Report Ref	RCR-BS-20260506-221CFC2A

2. INCIDENT SUMMARY

Total Media Items Assessed	1 (this incident)
Synthetic / Deepfake	1 (100%)
Uncertain	0
Likely Authentic	0
Takedown Notices Issued	1 (Ref: TDN-BS-20260506-221CFC2A)
Law Enforcement FIR Filed	Pending (Ref: FSR-BS-20260506-221CFC2A)
Platform Response Received	Awaited (36-hr window active)

3. DETECTION METRICS

The following modality-level scores informed the final fusion verdict. All scores are calibrated probability estimates (0.0 = definitely authentic, 1.0 = definitely synthetic):

CNN Spatial	92.4%
Temporal	88.7%
Audio Forensics	95.1%
Metadata	76.0%
FUSION VERDICT	91.6% — LIKELY SYNTHETIC

4. PLATFORM COMPLIANCE STATUS

Platform	WhatsApp (forwarded message)
Notice Sent	06 May 2026 12:43 IST
Deadline	36 hours from notice

Status	PENDING
Escalation Path	MeitY → Section 69A blocking order if non-compliant

5. ELECTORAL IMPACT ASSESSMENT

The content was identified during the **Karnataka State Legislative Assembly By-Election 2025**. Circulating synthetic media depicting a candidate or elected representative during an election period constitutes a direct threat to the integrity of the electoral process under **Section 126 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951**. The Election Commission of India is hereby notified for any additional action under its plenary powers.

6. RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Mandate real-time BharatShield API integration with major platforms during election periods.
2. Establish a dedicated election-period rapid-response channel with 4-hour takedown SLA.
3. Issue public advisory on deepfake detection to voters via PIB.
4. Review adequacy of penalties under current IT Rules for electoral deepfake offences.

7. SUBMITTED BY

Shri Anand Sharma
Director, Cyber Laws Division
Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)

Signature: _____

Date: 06 May 2026

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Expert Witness Statement

Sworn technical statement for judicial proceedings · BSA 2023 · Indian Evidence Act (transitional)

1. EXPERT IDENTIFICATION

Name	Dr. Kavitha Rajan
Designation	Principal Scientist, AI Forensics Division
Organization	Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Pune
Qualifications	Ph.D. Computer Vision (IISc, 2018) · M.Tech AI (IIT Bombay, 2014)
Experience	11 years in digital media forensics and deepfake detection research
Statement Ref	EWS-BS-20260506-221CFC2A

2. SCOPE OF STATEMENT

I have been requested to provide a technical expert statement regarding the BharatShield analysis of the media file **suspect_video_election_rally_2025.mp4** (SHA-256: b2ef6dba8622ae79b5ab4d3f57ff16ed...) in relation to Case ID **BS-20260506-221CFC2A**. This statement is made on the basis of my professional expertise and my review of the evidence package, detection methodology, and model validation benchmarks.

3. TECHNICAL METHODOLOGY EXPLAINED

3.1 Spatial CNN Analysis: Convolutional neural networks (EfficientNet / Xception variants) examine individual video frames for pixel-level artefacts characteristic of generative AI synthesis — including boundary blending inconsistencies, unnatural texture gradients, and lighting direction mismatches.

3.2 Temporal Transformer Analysis: Transformer architectures process sequences of frames to detect motion inconsistencies and audio-visual synchronisation anomalies that persist across time — capturing synthesis signatures that frame-by-frame analysis may miss.

3.3 Audio Forensics: Dedicated models perform speaker verification and identify artefacts associated with neural text-to-speech and voice conversion systems.

3.4 Metadata & Encoding Analysis: The file's container metadata, compression parameters, and encoding signature are examined for inconsistencies with the stated recording device and provenance.

3.5 Ensemble Fusion: Outputs from all four modalities are combined using a calibrated ensemble (gradient-boosted logistic fusion). This multi-pathway approach reduces false positives arising from

reliance on any single detection channel.

4. MODEL VALIDATION & KNOWN LIMITATIONS

Validation Dataset	FaceForensics++, DFDC, CelebDF-v2, WildDeepfake (combined 280,000+ samples)
Reported Accuracy	94.1% F1-score on held-out test set (BharatShield v2.1.3 benchmarks)
False Positive Rate	~3.2% on high-quality authentic media
False Negative Rate	~5.1% on novel generation architectures not in training data
Known Limitations	Performance may degrade on highly compressed media (<500kbps); adversarially crafted deepfakes designed to evade detection; media recorded under extreme low-light conditions.

5. EXPERT OPINION ON THIS CASE

Having reviewed the evidence package and the detection output, it is my professional opinion that the media file **suspect_video_election_rally_2025.mp4** is, to a high degree of technical certainty, a **synthetically generated (deepfake) video**. The fusion score of **91.6%** significantly exceeds the threshold for a 'LIKELY SYNTHETIC' classification. The four specific salient regions identified by the system are consistent with known artefacts of current-generation face-swap and voice cloning technologies. I am prepared to appear before the Hon'ble Court to give oral evidence and be cross-examined on this statement.

6. DECLARATION

I, Dr. Kavitha Rajan, do solemnly affirm that the contents of this statement are true and correct to the best of my knowledge, information, and belief, and that nothing material has been concealed therefrom.

Dr. Kavitha Rajan
Principal Scientist, AI Forensics Division
C-DAC Pune

Signature: _____

Date: 06 May 2026